AEO for the Strategic Leader

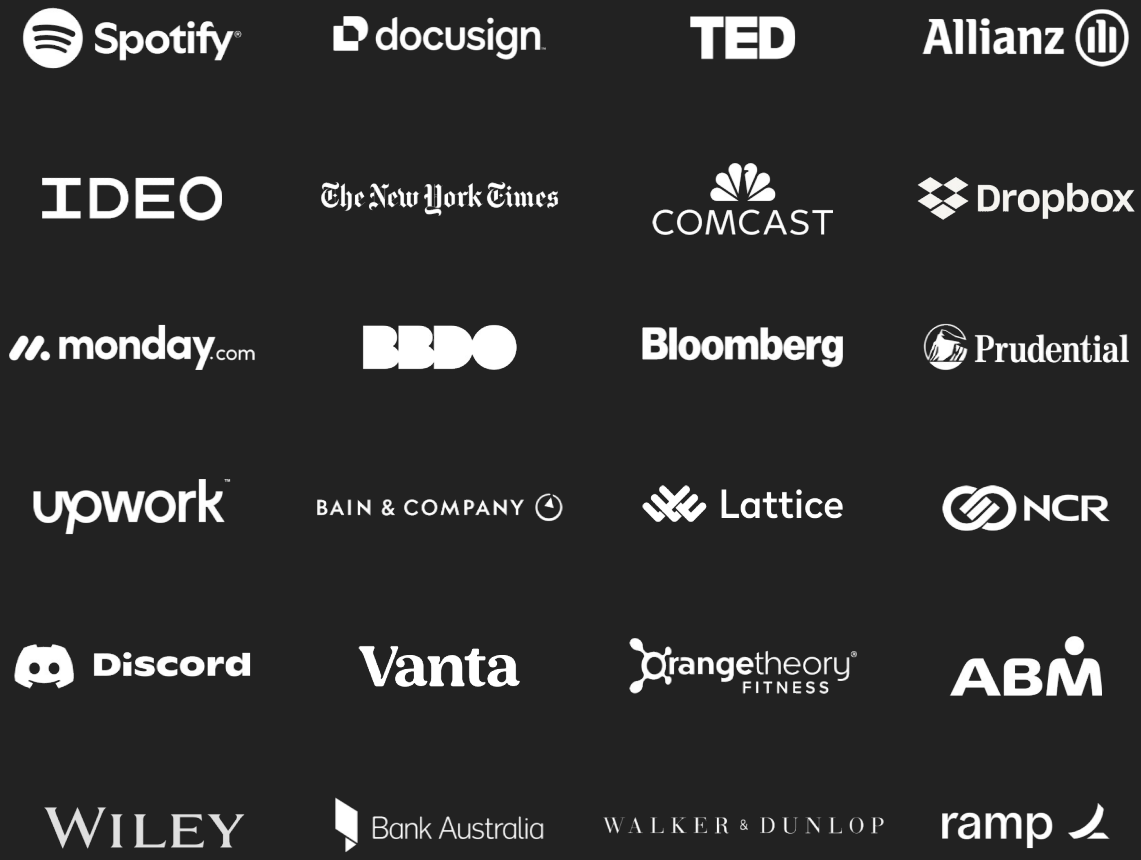
(and one more thing)



Guy Yalif
Chief Evangelist, Webflow

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Trusted by marketing, design and engineering teams at over 300,000 of the world's leading organizations



Webflow

Traffic

15-25%

decrease in organic traffic

Source: Bain, 2025

Usefulness

94%

of b2b buyers used genAI in their most recent purchase

Source: Forrester, 2026

Impact

69%

of b2b buyers chose a different vendor based on AI chats

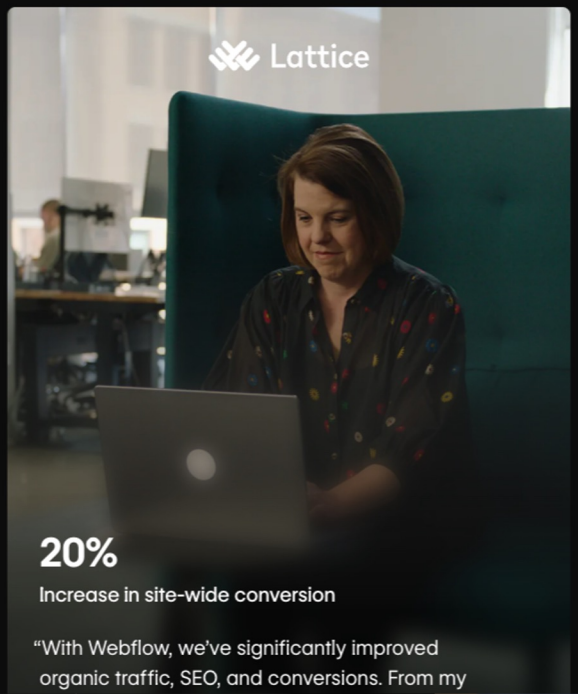
Source: G2, 2026

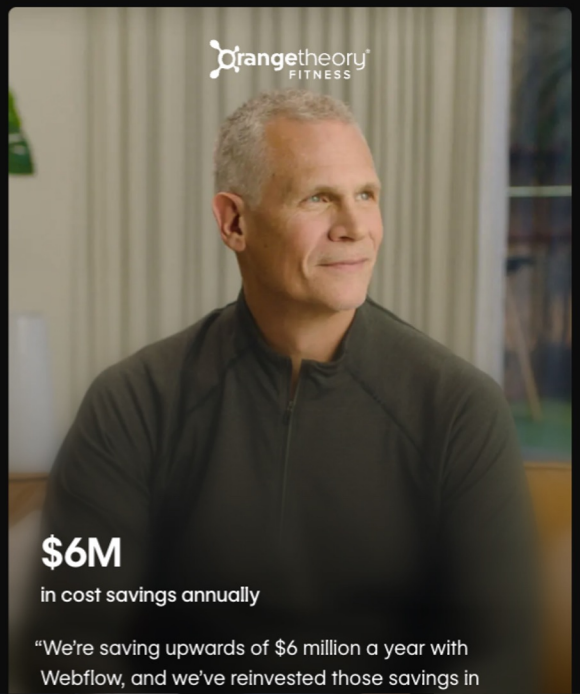
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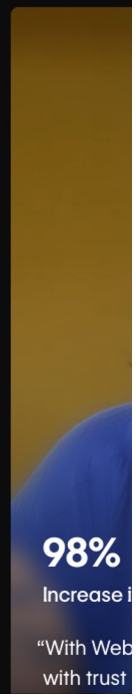
Your website has two audiences

300,000+ brands move the needle with Webflow





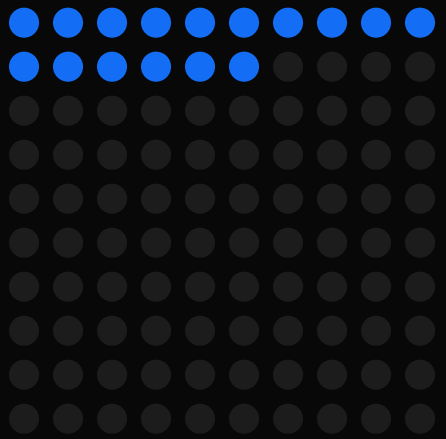




Most brands aren’t showing up as much as they want

16%

Mention rate (median)



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Source: Webflow AEO Maturity Index Jul ‘26, an analysis of 2,000 US websites across industries and company size

Nor are they getting links as much as they want

6 %

Citation rate (median)



Cited in just 6 of every 100 answers.

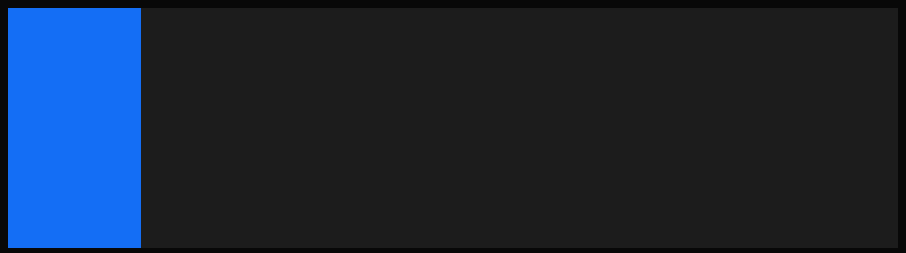
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Source: Webflow AEO Maturity Index Jul ‘26, an analysis of 2,000 US websites across industries and company size

Nor owning as much of the conversation

15 %

Competitive share of voice



Webflow

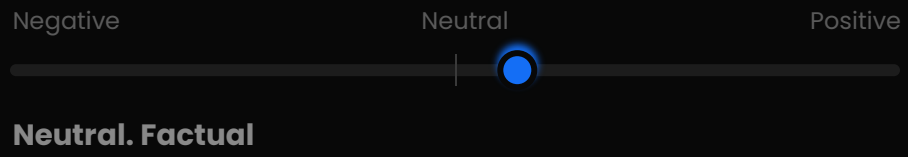
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Source: Webflow AEO Maturity Index Jul ‘26, an analysis of 2,000 US websites across industries and company size

Nor showing up as they would like

57 out of 100

Sentiment (median)



Neutral. Factual

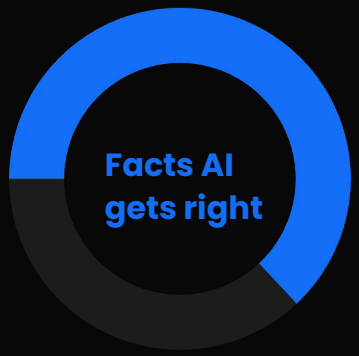
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Source: Webflow AEO Maturity Index Jul ‘26, an analysis of 2,000 US websites across industries and company size

Nor showing up as they would like

63 out of 100

Accuracy (median)



Typical mention is a mix of correct and incorrect information about the brand

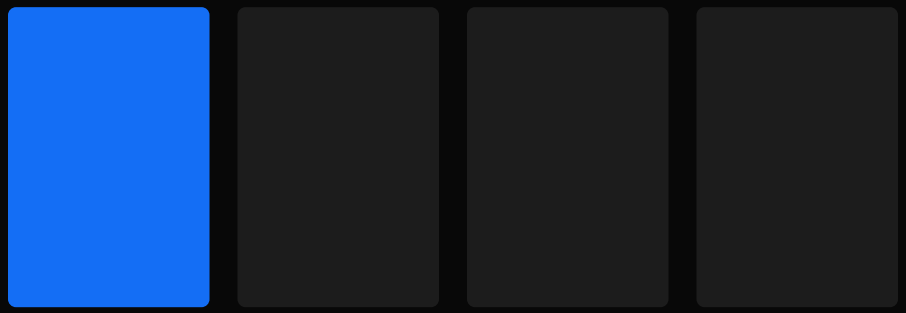
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Source: Webflow AEO Maturity Index Jul ‘26, an analysis of 2,000 US websites across industries and company size

Nor showing up as they would like

24 out of 100

Message pull-through (median)

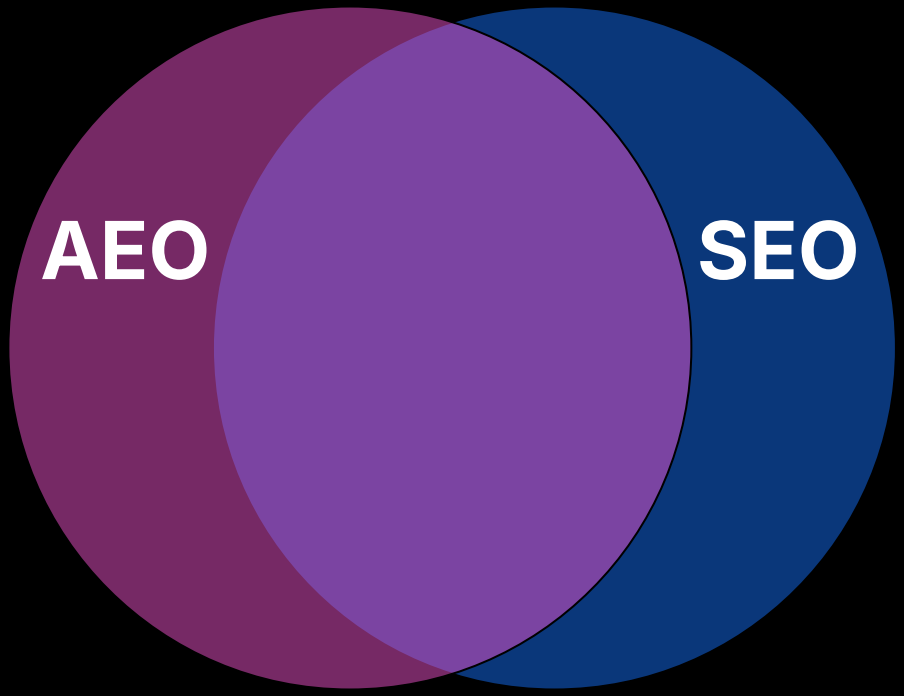


Little to no connection to your actual positioning

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Source: Webflow AEO Maturity Index Jul ‘26, an analysis of 2,000 US websites across industries and company size

AEO is close to what good SEO always should have been



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AEO vs SEO in four categories



Content

Keywords → answers → personalization



Technical

SEO → automated site structure → speed



Authority

Backlinks → widespread, positive mentions

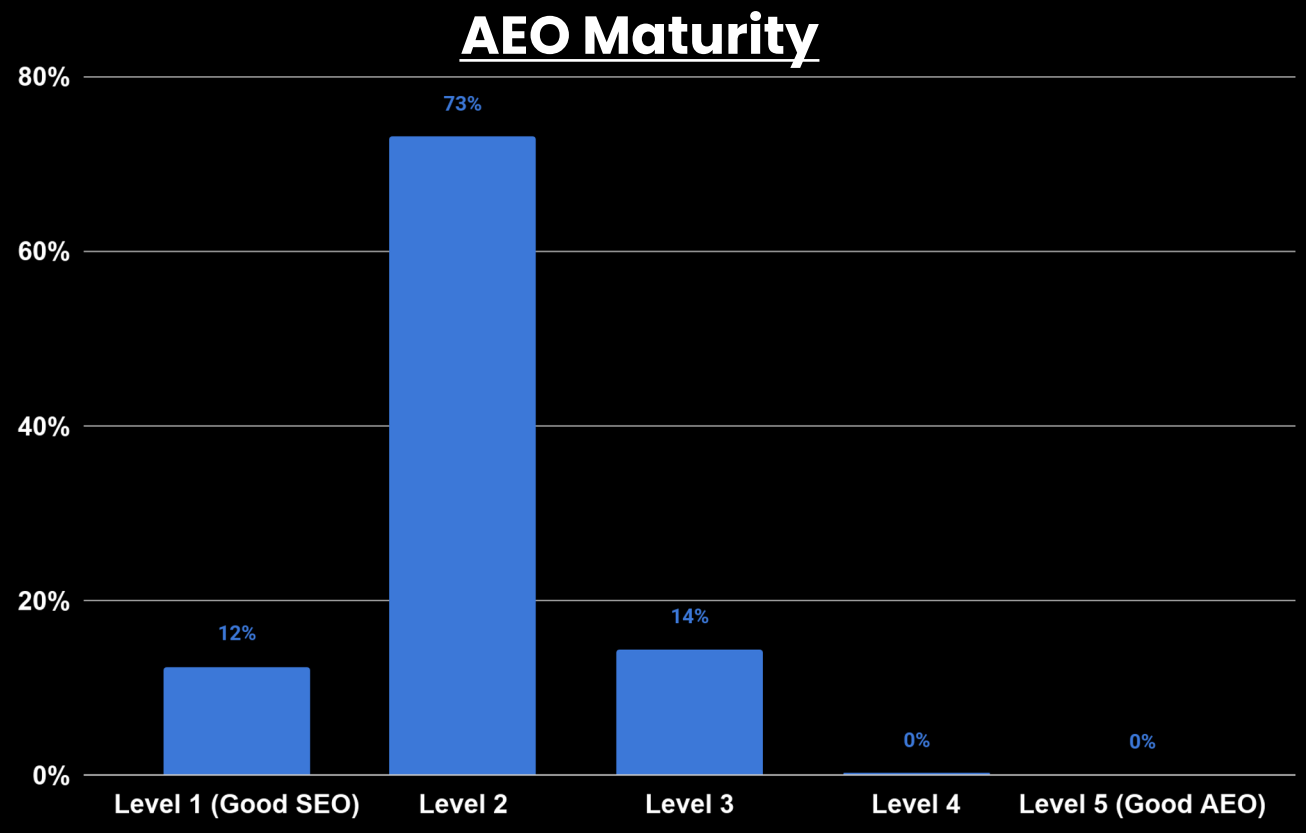


Measurement

Keyword ranking → mentions → SOV

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It is early days for all of us in a new medium

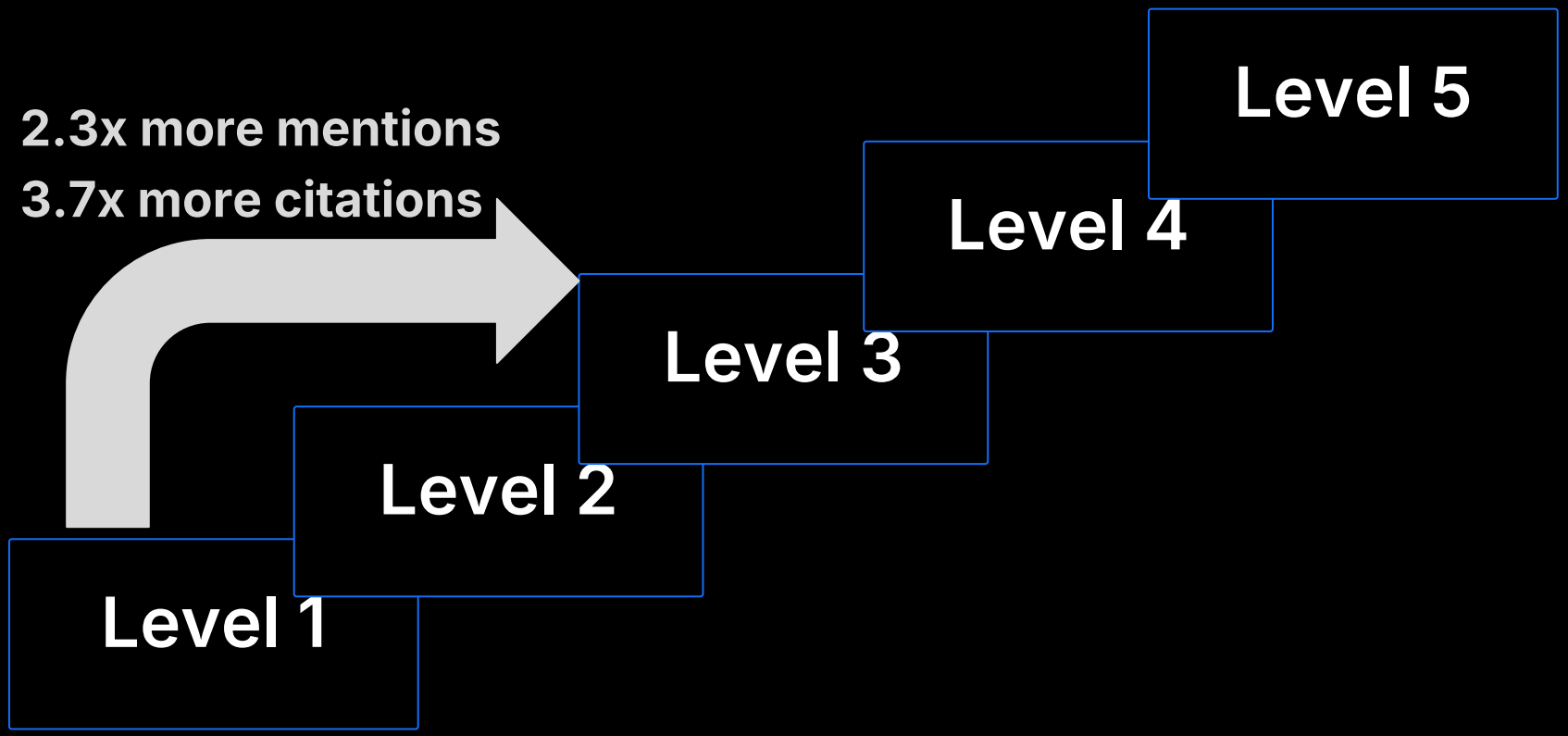


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Source: Webflow AEO Maturity Index Jul ‘26, an analysis of 2,000 US websites across industries and company size

The benefits of AEO maturity are large

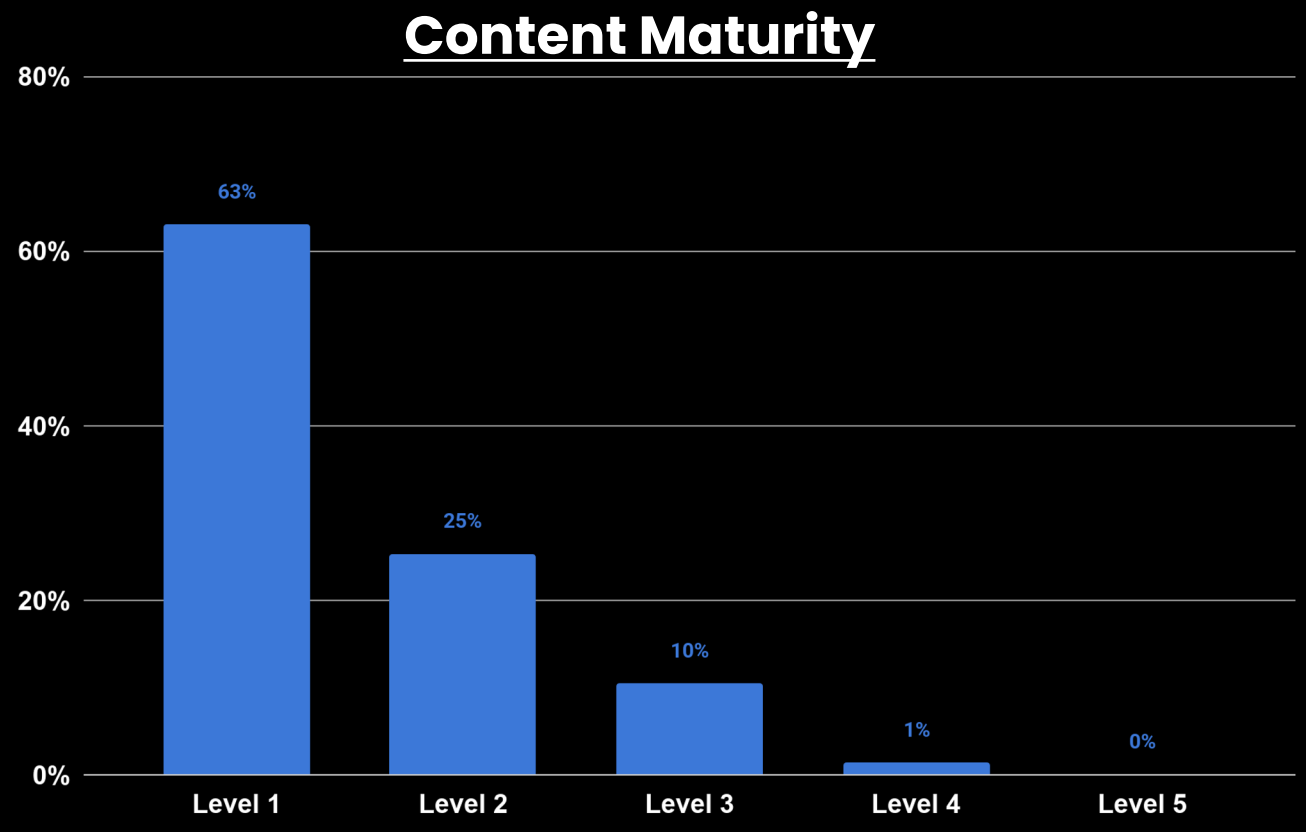


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Source: Webflow AEO Maturity Index Jul ‘26, an analysis of 2,000 US websites across industries and company size

It is early days in a new medium: content



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Source: Webflow AEO Maturity Index Jul ‘26, an analysis of 2,000 US websites across industries and company size

Fundamentals holding us back

57%

not answering prospects' questions

Source: Webflow AEO Maturity Index Jul '26, an analysis of 2,000 US websites across industries and company size

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Topics become baskets of questions in AEO

Generate with AI Recommended

We will generate prompts and group them into topics using the existing context

Prompts

Topics	Visibility score	Citation rate
Website roles and personas 4 active prompts	93% ↗ 1%	25% ↘ -2%
How-to workflows 6 active prompts	43% ↘ -1%	28% ↗ 4%
Website Definitions 7 active prompts	41% ↗ 4%	28% ↗ 3%
How does responsive design work?	0% --	0% --
What are interactions and animations in web design?	18% ↗ 14%	85% ↗ 21%
What is a headless CMS?	4% ↗ 4%	0% --
What is a visual website builder?	68% ↗ 4%	0% --
What does a web designer use to build client sites?	100% --	77% ↘ -2%
What's the difference between a CMS and a website builder?	29% ↗ 7%	0% --
What is no-code web design?	68% ↘ -4%	0% --
Website platform recommendations 7 active prompts	98% ↘ -1%	22% ↗ 2%

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Fundamentals holding us back

54%

stale content

Note: stale is define as under 10% of content updated in the past six months
Source: Webflow AEO Maturity Index Jul ‘26, an analysis of 2,000 US websites across industries and company size

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Freshness matters

95% of ChatGPT citations were updated in the last 10 months

Speed & efficiency

5x

Content refreshes

Traffic

+42%

Avg. SEO Visits post-update

Conversions

+14%

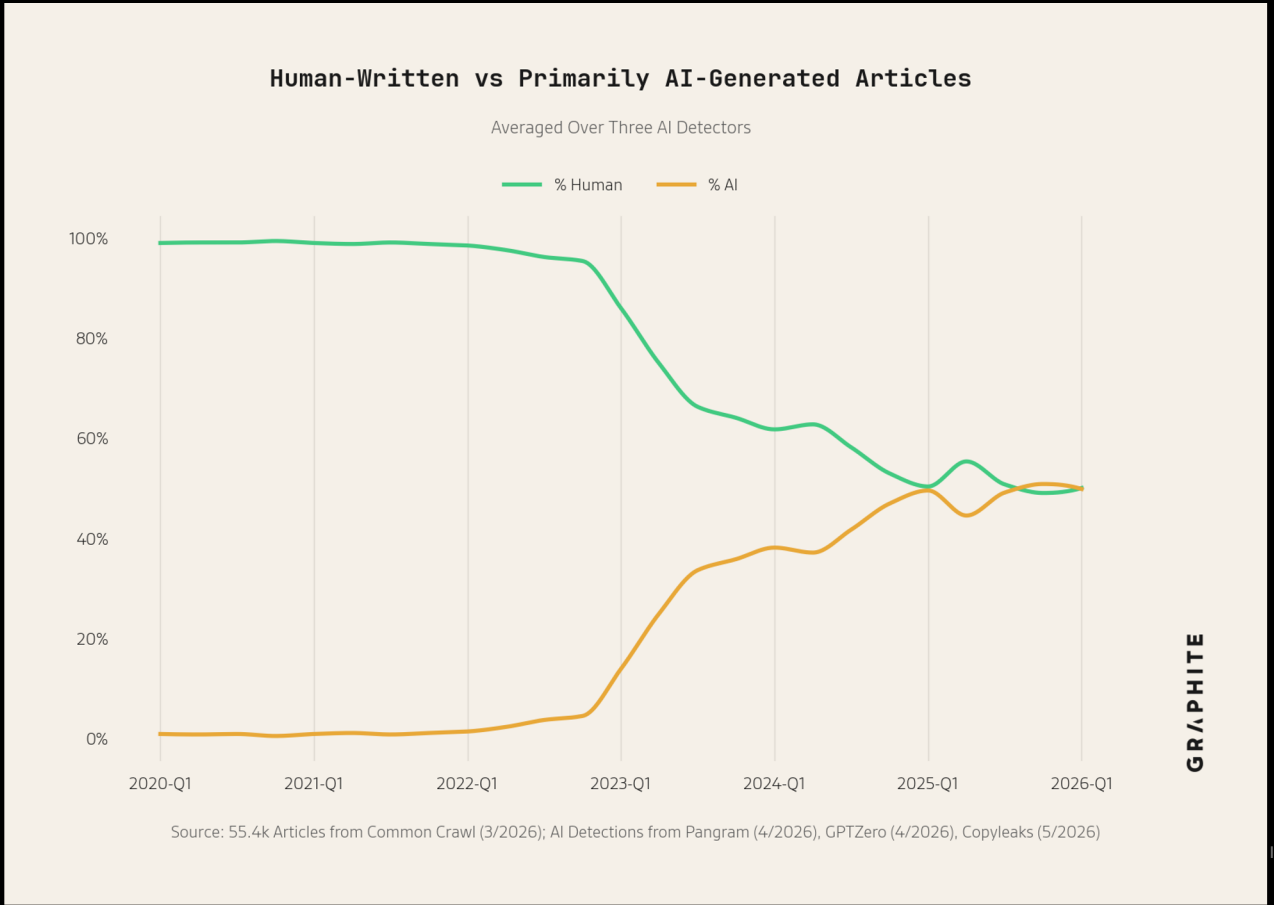
Avg. SEO Signups post-update

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Source: Webflow data and AirOps https://www.growth-memo.com/p/ai-halftime-report-h1-2025

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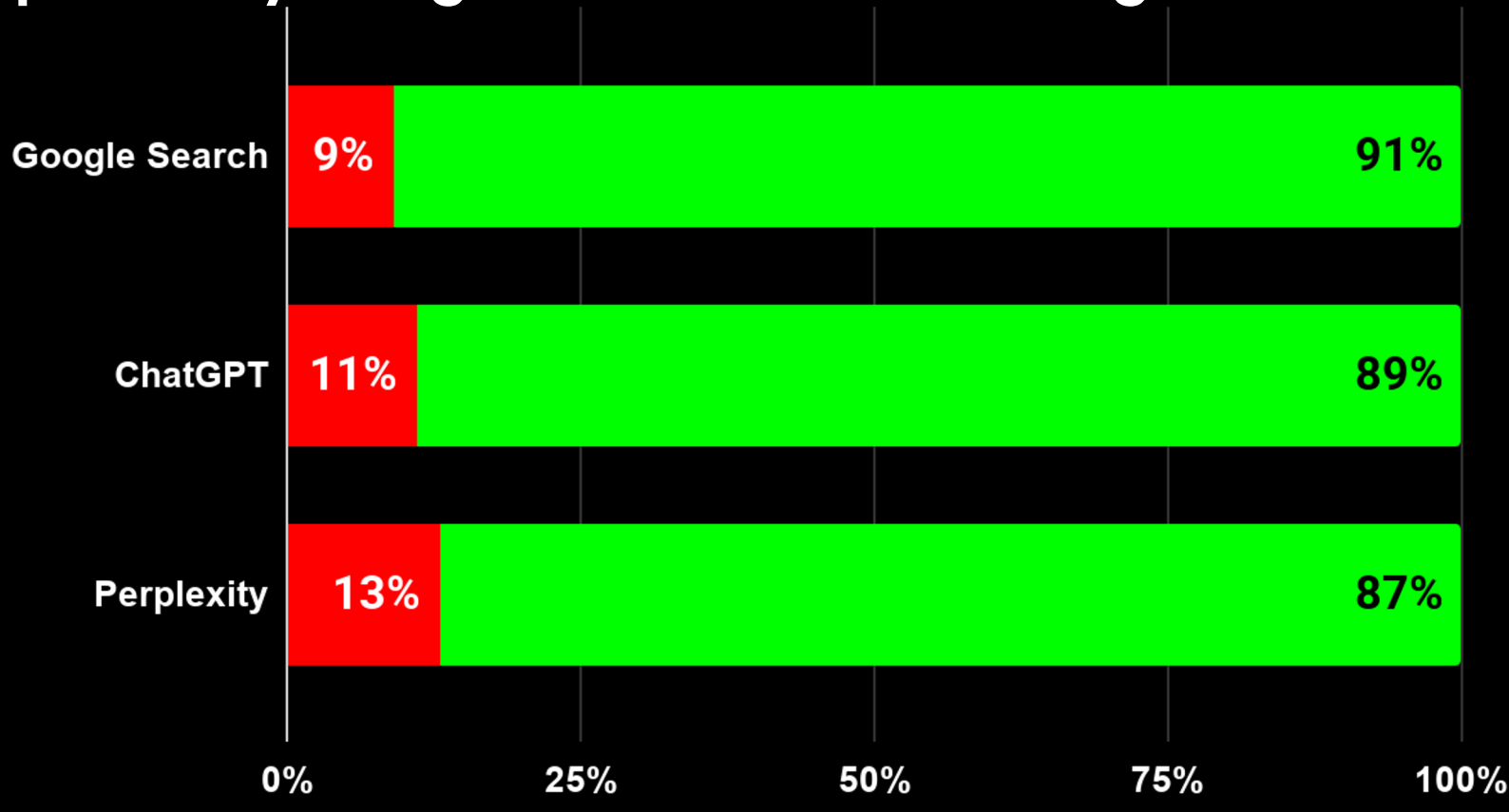
Humans and primarily-AI-generated write roughly equal numbers of articles now



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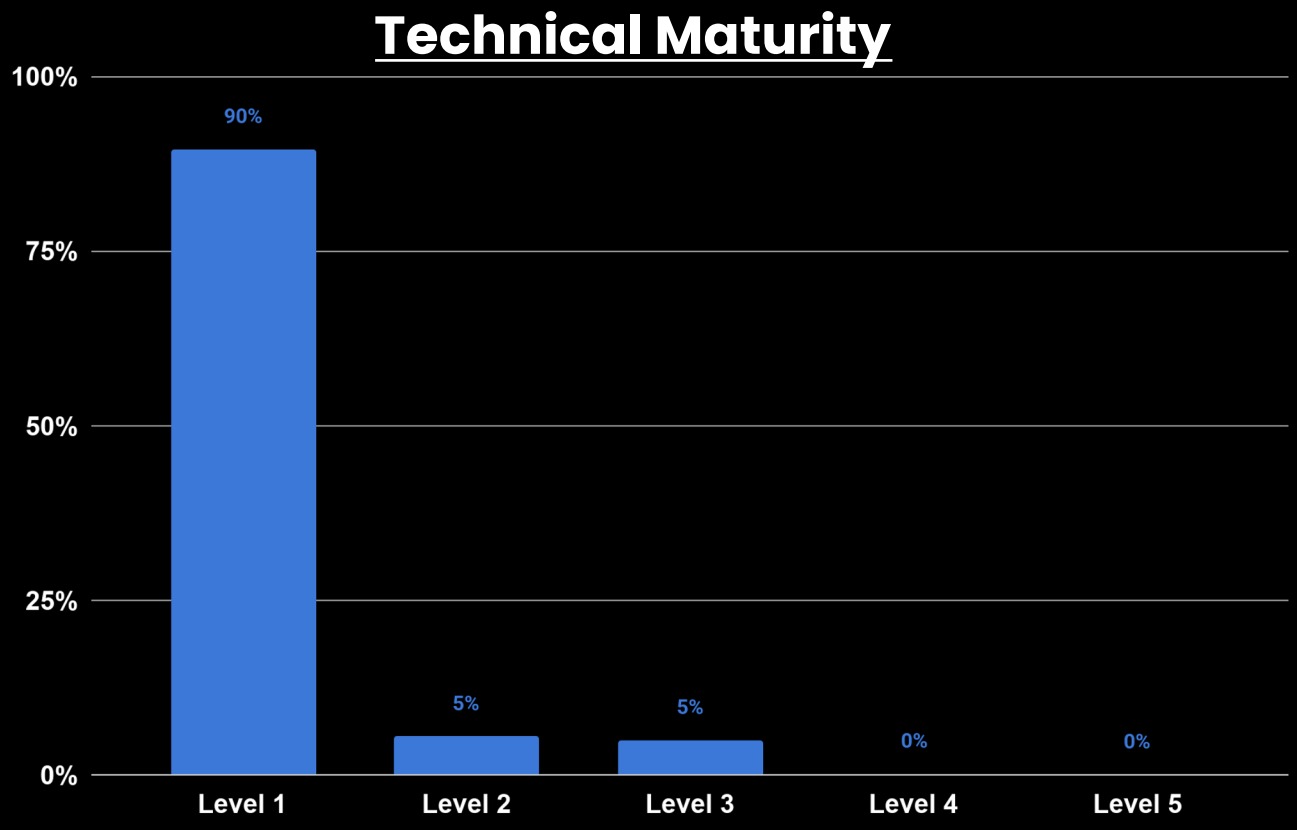
But primarily-AI-generated isn't ranking



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It is early days in a new medium: technical



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Source: Webflow AEO Maturity Index Jul ‘26, an analysis of 2,000 US websites across industries and company size

Fundamentals holding us back

62%

broken internal links

Note: broken internal links defined as more than 10% of internal links lead nowhere
Source: Webflow AEO Maturity Index Jul ‘26, an analysis of 2,000 US websites across industries and company size

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Fundamentals holding us back

61%

illogical heading structure

Note: illogical heading structure defined as broken H1 → H2 → H3 hierarchy on 40%+ of pages
Source: Webflow AEO Maturity Index Jul ‘26, an analysis of 2,000 US websites across industries and company size

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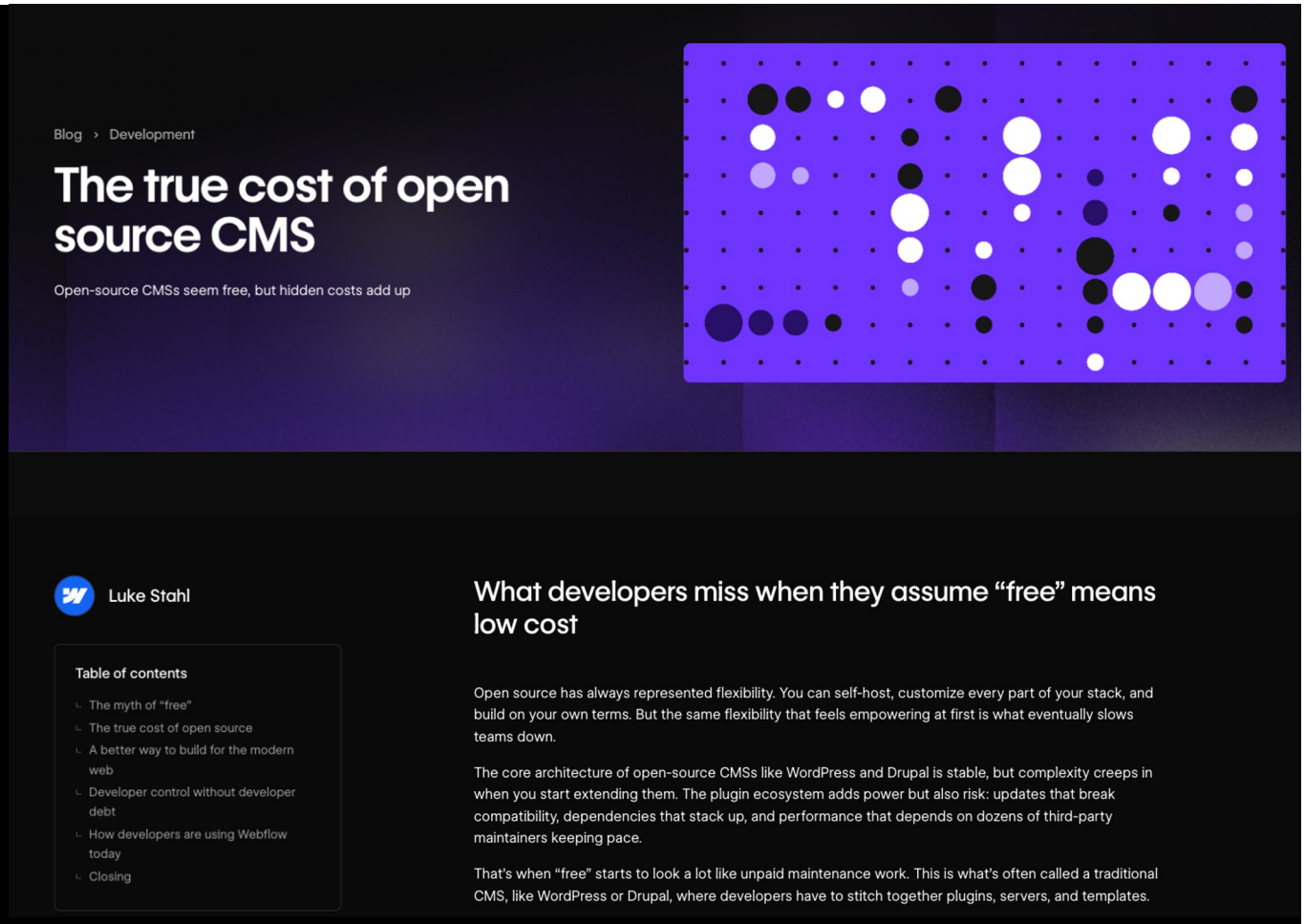
Add table of contents in blog posts

59%

more AI-sourced traffic in four weeks

23%

more SEO traffic in four weeks



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Fundamentals holding us back

60%

missing SEO metadata

Note: missing SEO metadata defined as missing page titles or descriptions on 20%+ of pages
Source: Webflow AEO Maturity Index Jul ‘26, an analysis of 2,000 US websites across industries and company size

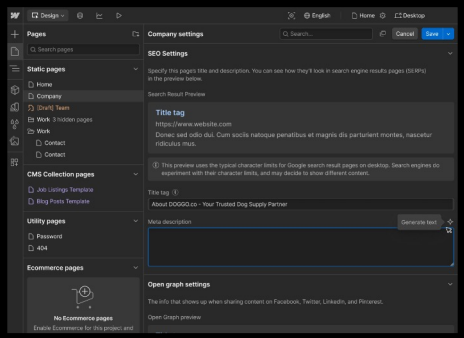
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Metadata reduces cost for LLMs to consume your site

1

SEO metadata

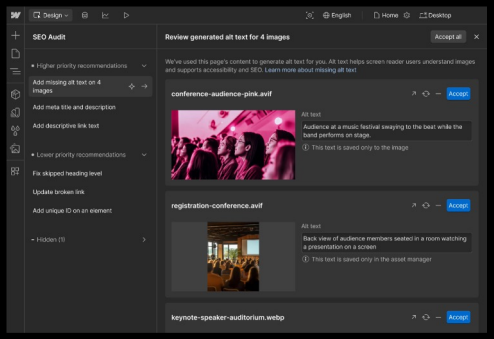
Page title and description should be universal and accurate



2

Alt text at scale

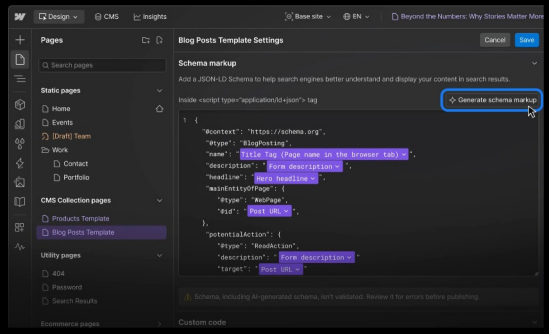
Easier for machines to ingest alt text than images (and video transcripts over videos)



3

Schema markup

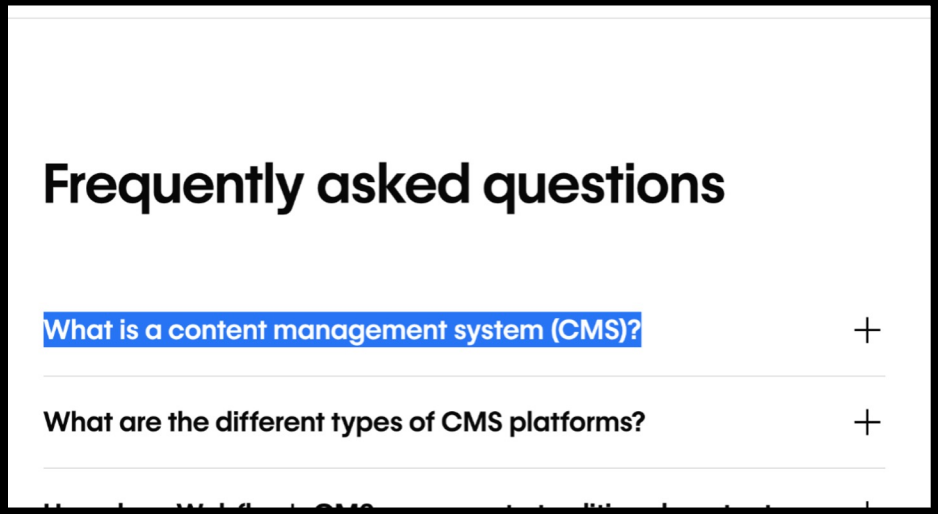
Detailed structure and meaning signals across 100's of different page types



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webflow.com added FAQ + schema to top 6 product pgs





57%

of new citations in following 2 weeks came from these 6 pages (we have thousands)

24%

lift in organic impressions in two weeks

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It is still early days

73%

of first-page results in Google use schema

12%

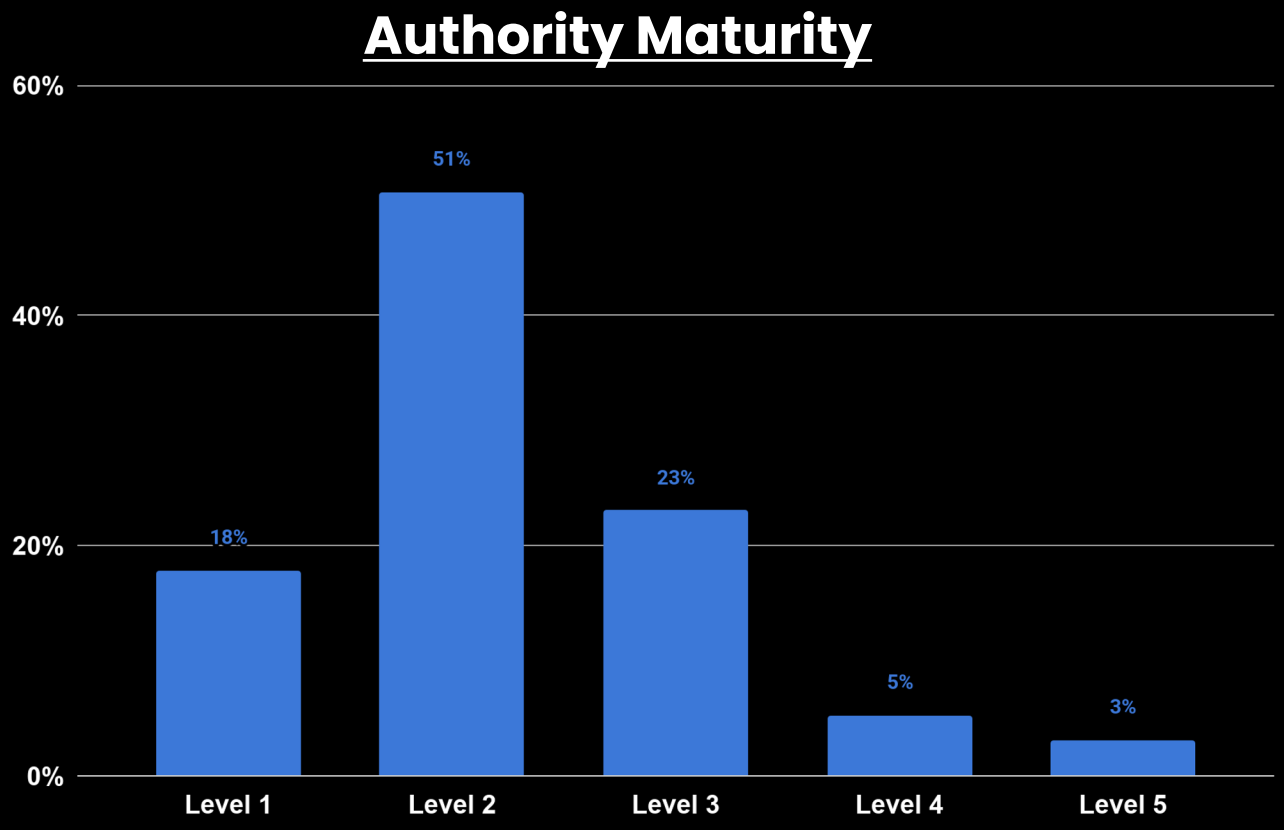
of sites have implemented schema

42%

increase in citations received for content with structured data

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It is early days in a new medium: technical



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Source: Webflow AEO Maturity Index Jul ‘26, an analysis of 2,000 US websites across industries and company size

Fundamentals holding us back

73%

lack of widespread mentions

Note: lack of widespread mentions defined as mentioned on fewer than 25% of the sites AI cites for your category
Source: Webflow AEO Maturity Index Jul ‘26, an analysis of 2,000 US websites across industries and company size

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Brand is back because LLMS value consensus and popularity

(so is PR)

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Fundamentals holding us back

55%

hiding topic authority

Note: hiding topic authority defined as no author byline on 85%+ of pages that need one to signal expertise
Source: Webflow AEO Maturity Index Jul ‘26, an analysis of 2,000 US websites across industries and company size

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External expertise lifted both channels for webflow.com

14%

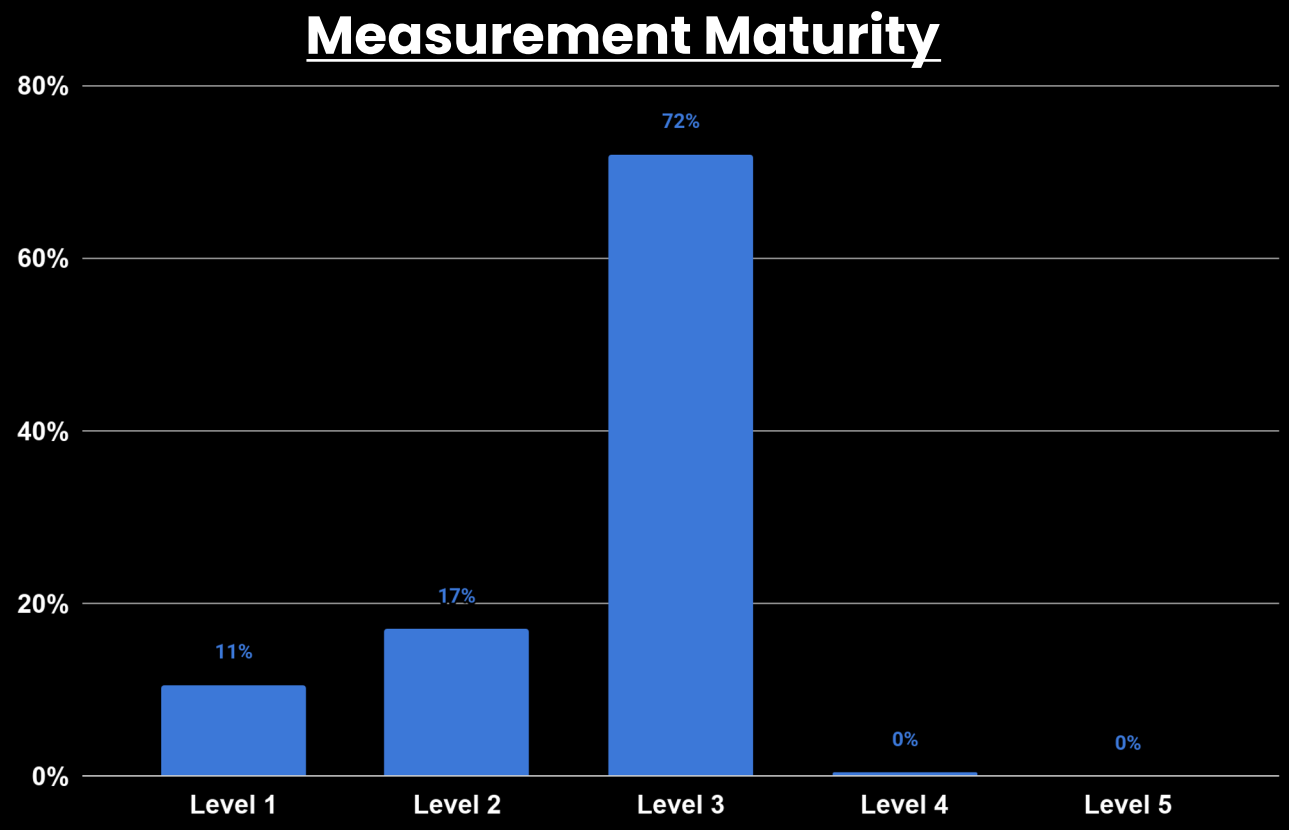
Increase in AI driven traffic

8%

increase in search traffic

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It is early days for in a new medium: measurement

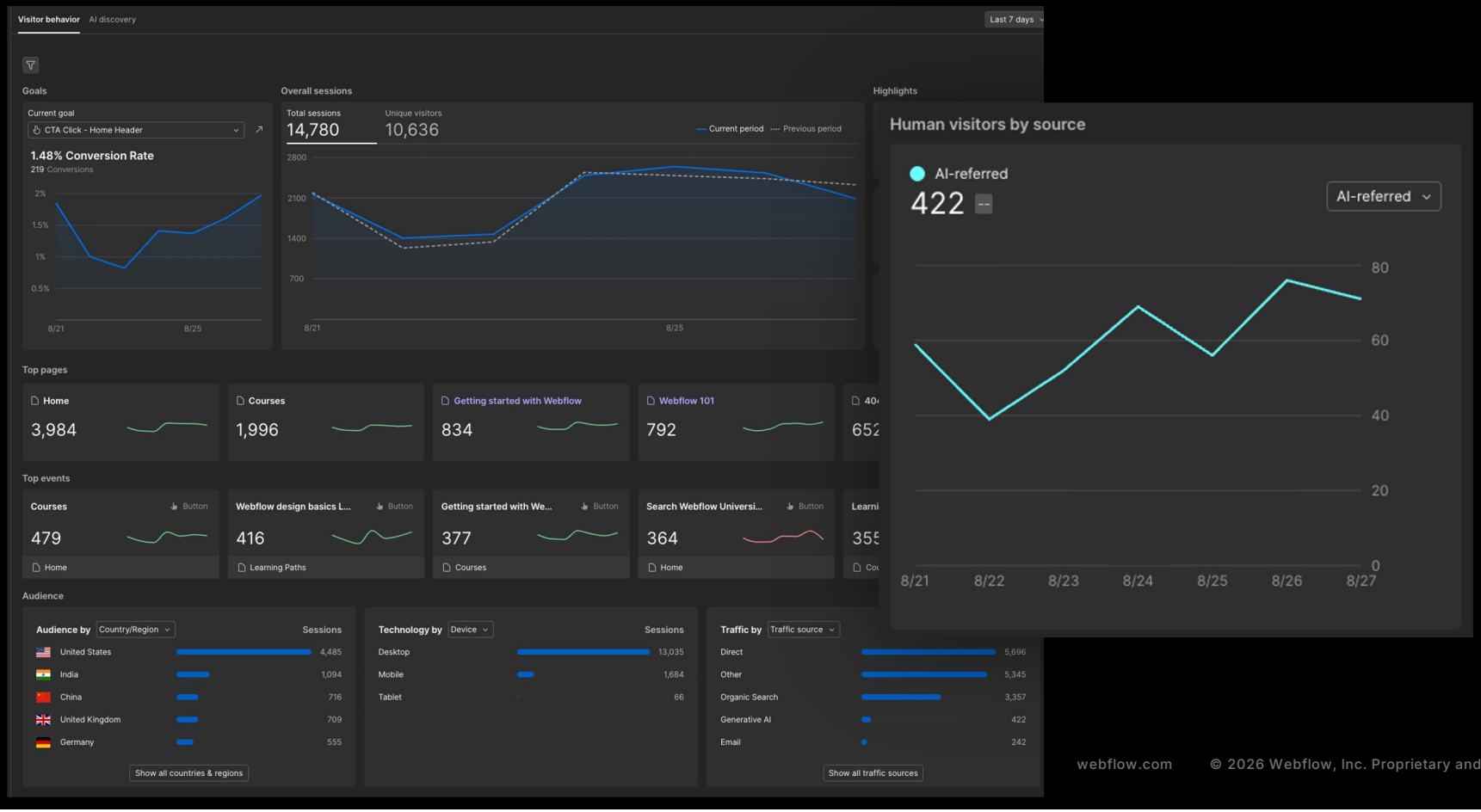


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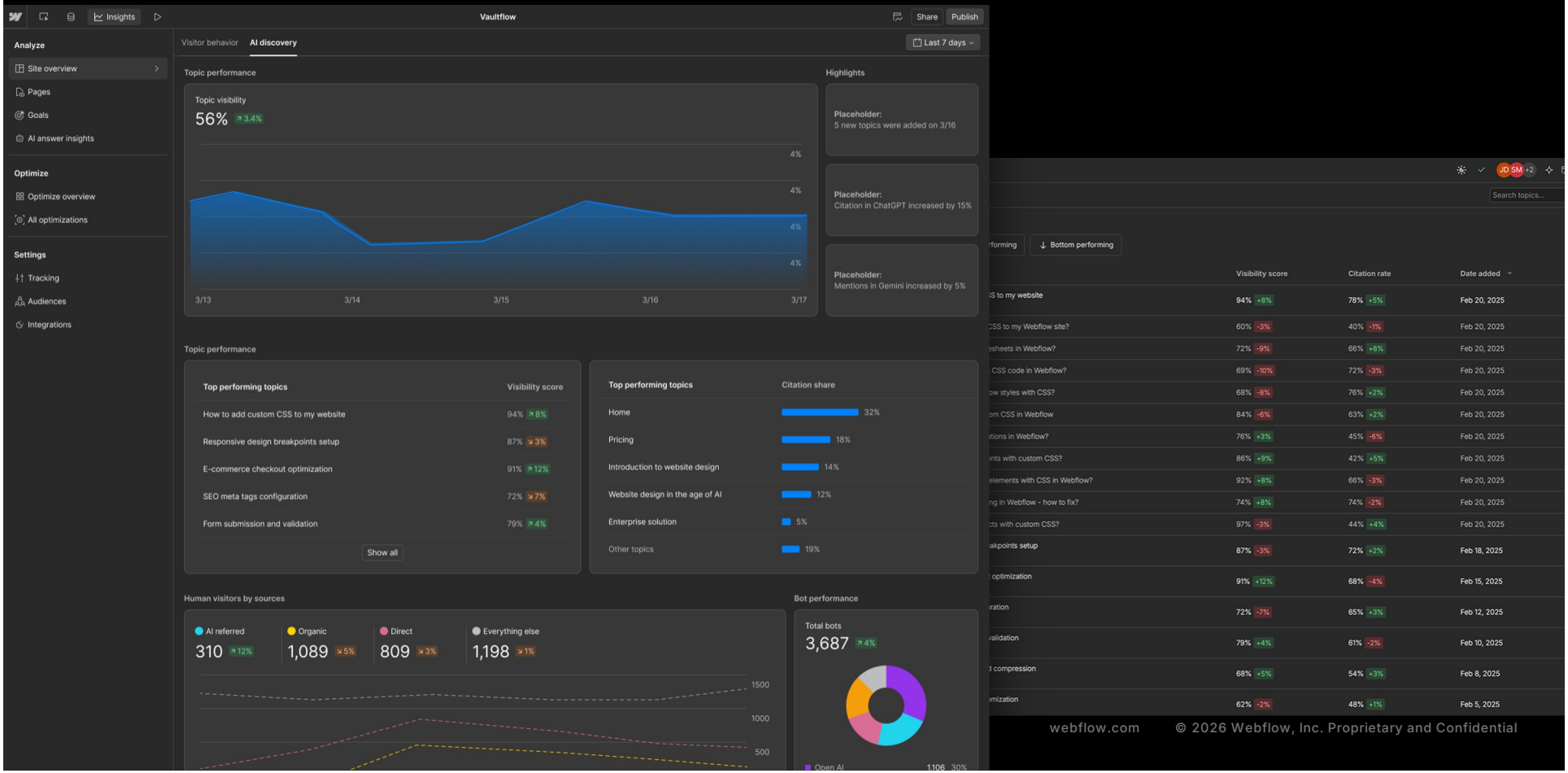
Source: Webflow AEO Maturity Index Jul ‘26, an analysis of 2,000 US websites across industries and company size

On site LLM-referred traffic and conversion rate

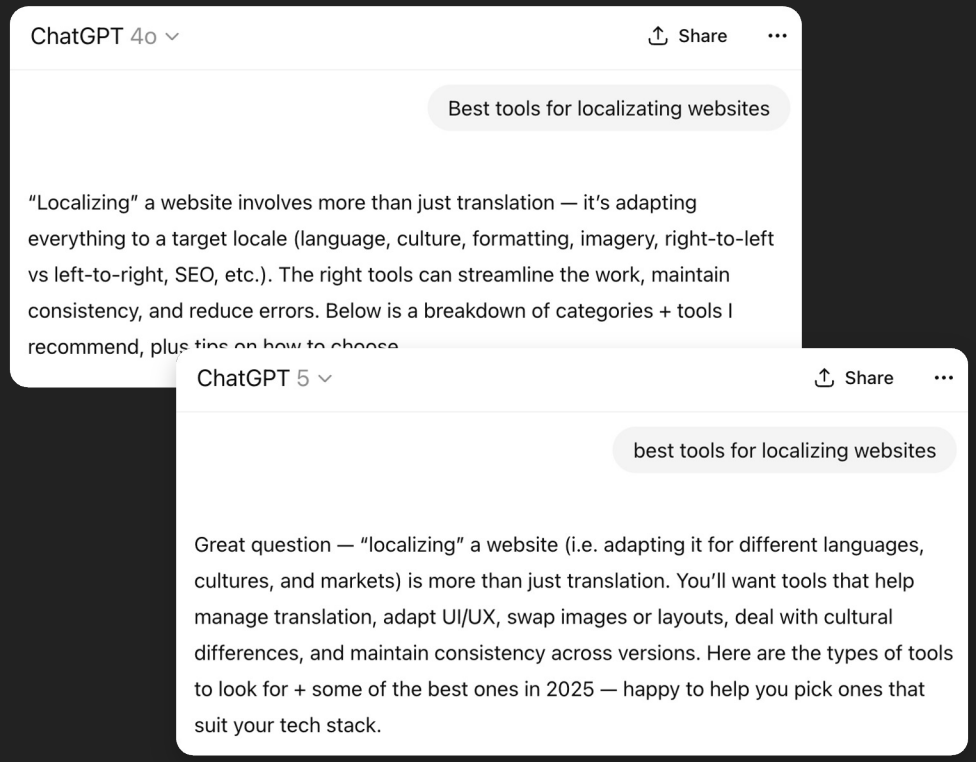


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Mention rate + citation rate (and more)



What GPT-5.4 said yesterday, GPT-5.5 rewrote today

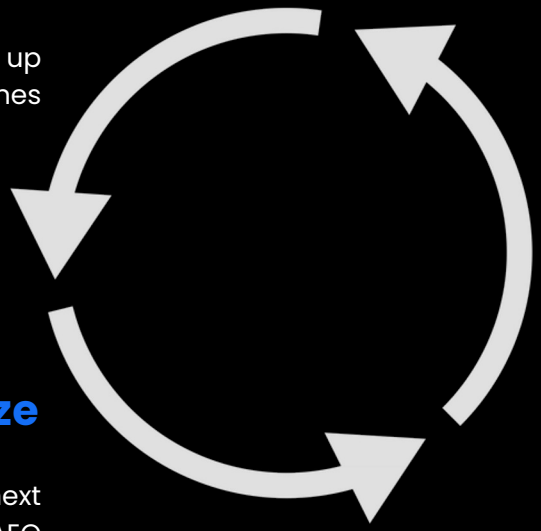


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Turning a website into an ongoing revenue driver

Measure

See how your brand shows up in answer engines



Act

Implement the hypothesis quickly and on brand

Hypothesize

Develop a hypothesis on the next thing to do to improve AEO

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AEO vs SEO in four categories



Content

Keywords → answers → personalization



Technical

SEO → automated site structure → speed



Authority

Backlinks → widespread, positive mentions



Measurement

Keyword ranking → mentions → SOV

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You can have a big impact. Today.

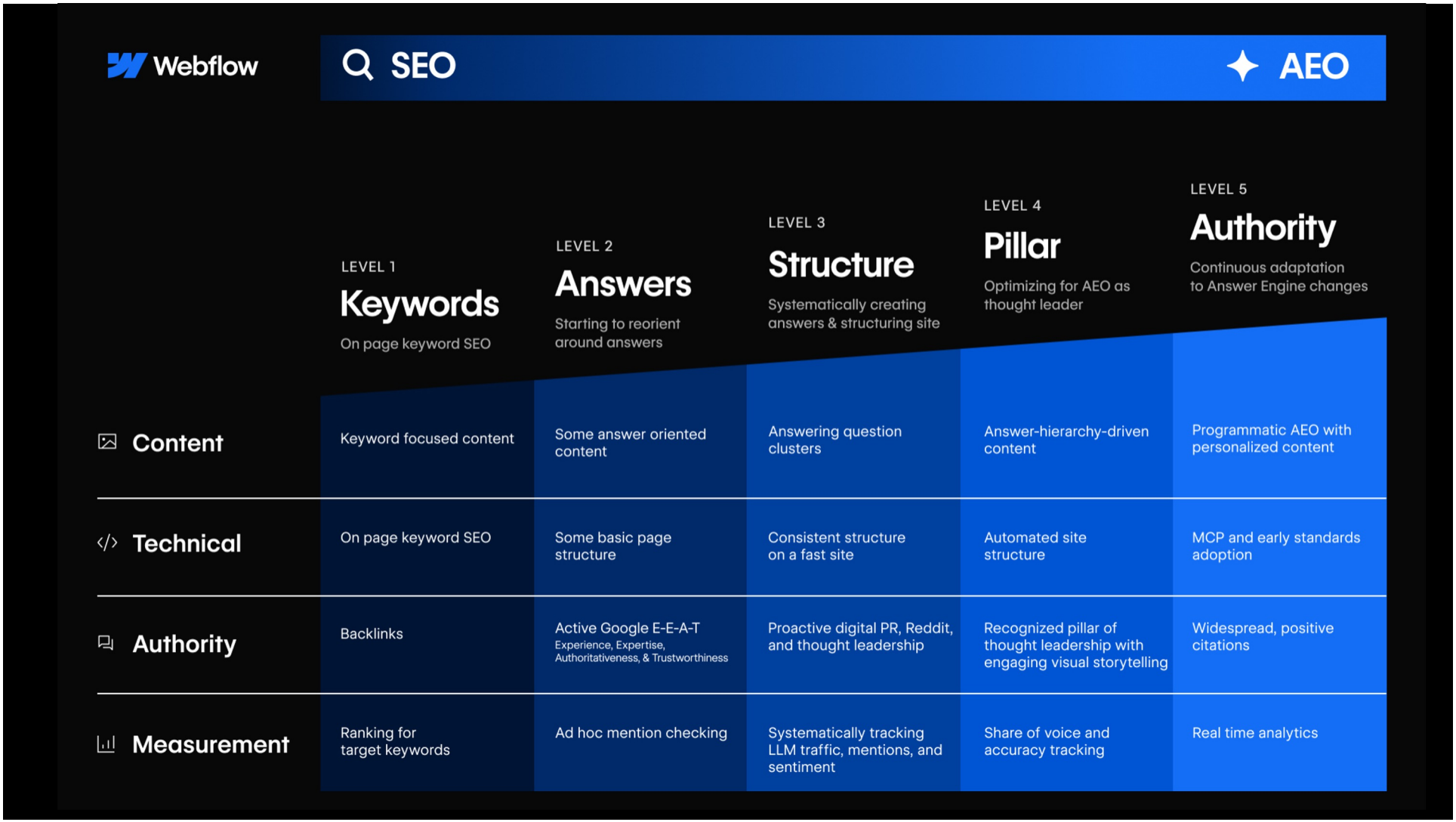
67%

Webflow visibility in the answers to questions our prospects are asking

#1

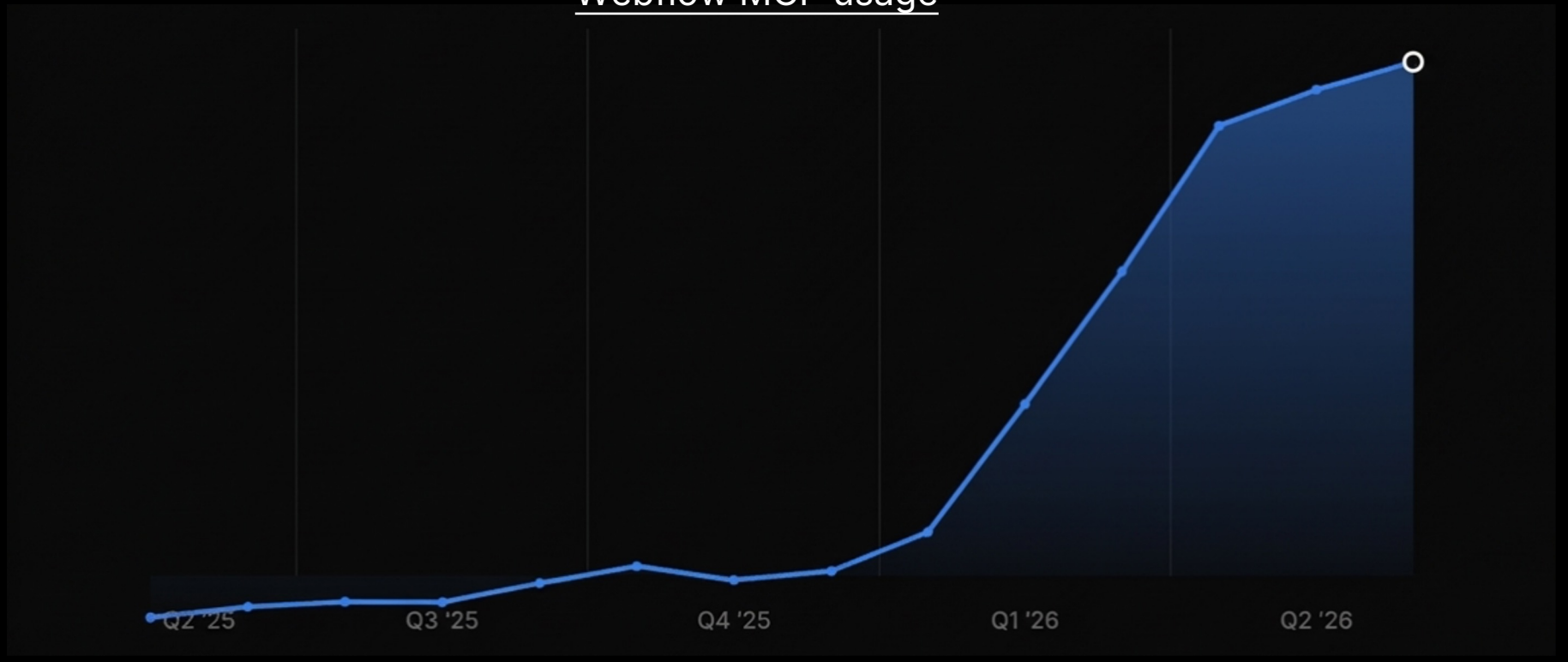
Webflow visibility vs competitors

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SEO
AEO
LEVEL 1
Keywords
On page keyword SEO
LEVEL 2
Answers
Starting to reorient around answers
LEVEL 3
Structure
Systematically creating answers & structuring site
LEVEL 4
Pillar
Optimizing for AEO as thought leader
LEVEL 5
Authority
Continuous adaptation to Answer Engine changes
Content
Keyword focused content
Some answer oriented content
Answering question clusters
Answer-hierarchy-driven content
Programmatic AEO with personalized content
Technical
On page keyword SEO
Some basic page structure
Consistent structure on a fast site
Automated site structure
MCP and early standards adoption
Authority
Backlinks
Active Google E-E-A-T
Experience, Expertise, Authoritativeness, & Trustworthiness
Proactive digital PR, Reddit, and thought leadership
Recognized pillar of thought leadership with engaging visual storytelling
Widespread, positive citations
Measurement
Ranking for target keywords
Ad hoc mention checking
Systematically tracking LLM traffic, mentions, and sentiment
Share of voice and accuracy tracking
Real time analytics

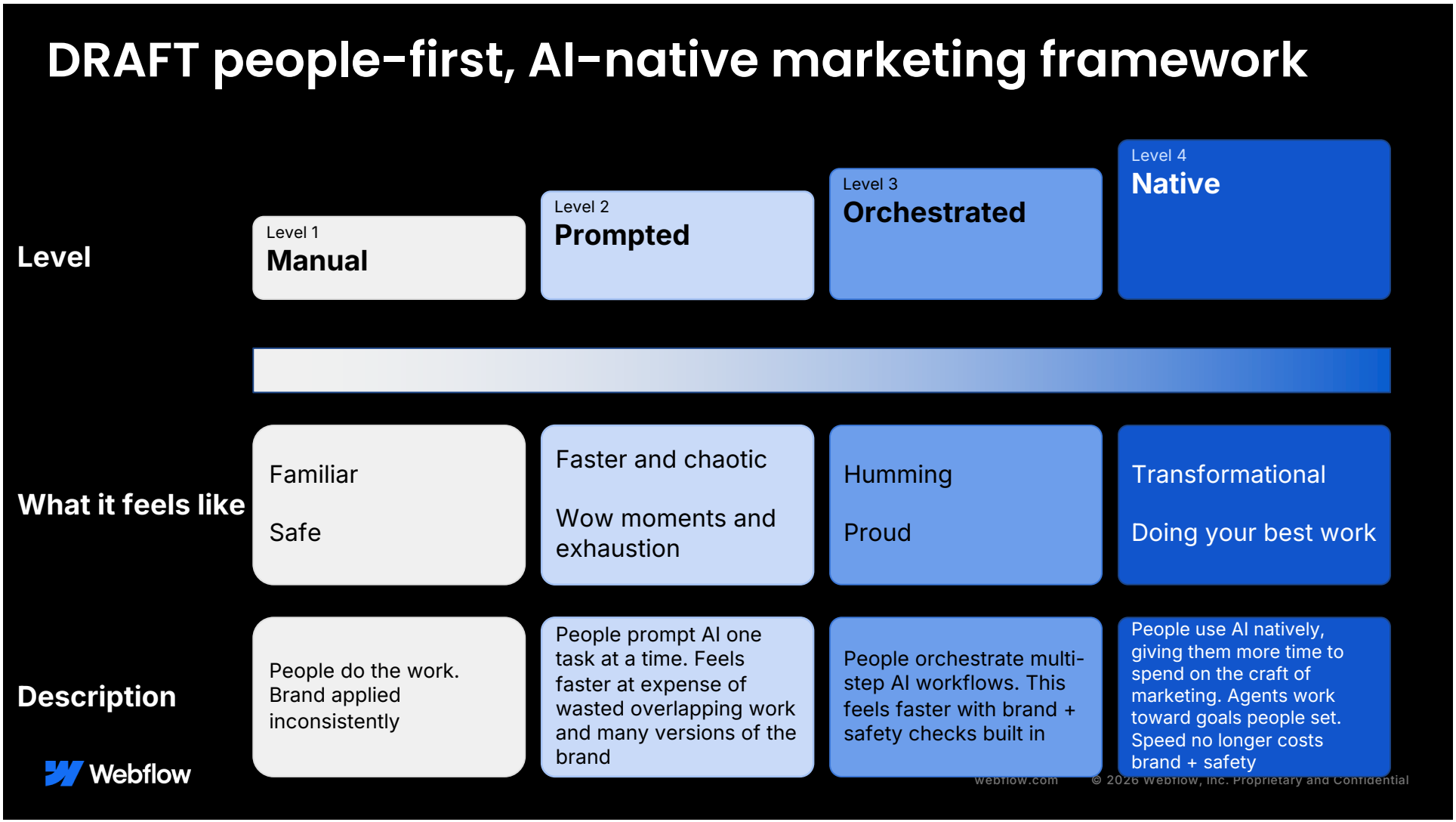
AI is (obviously) changing how marketing works

Webflow MCP usage



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DRAFT people-first, AI-native marketing framework



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DRAFT people-first, AI-native marketing framework

	Level 1 **Manual** People do the work. Brand applied inconsistently	Level 2 **Prompted** People prompt AI one task at a time. Feels faster at expense of wasted overlapping work and many versions of the brand	Level 3 **Orchestrated** People orchestrate multi-step AI workflows. This feels faster with brand + safety checks built in	Level 4 **Native** People use AI natively, giving them more time to spend on the craft of marketing. Agents work toward goals people set. Speed no longer costs brand + safety
What it feels like	Familiar Safe	Faster and chaotic Wow moments and exhaustion	Humming Proud	Transformational Doing your best work
How teams work	The team does the work and reviews most things. Production work competes heavily with time for craft	The team prompts one AI task at a time. A lot of time is spent chasing off-brand and duplicative work at the expense of craft	The team runs AI systems, starting the work and reviewing at checkpoints. Time and headspace free up, giving more room to craft	The team does its best work because they can focus on the craft of marketing. People lead AI by setting direction and defining what good looks like
AI's role	Nada	Do what the people tell it to do, step by step. Work often starts from scratch or sometimes from manually added context	Runs multi-step systems, pausing at regular checkpoints. Maintaining shared, lasting context	Initiate and run work based on predefined triggers. Keep iterating and flagging expections until the result is great
Brand + safety guardrails	Brand is generally consistent and lives in documents and people's heads. The team reviews most assets	Brand drifts from asset to asset. Output proliferates and Reviewers become the bottleneck or get skipped	Shared, persistent brand + safety guardrails get output close. Context governance eliminates most duplicative work and confusion	Work is on-brand and safe by default. People sample output
Business impact	Output capped by team capacity	Volume jumps while work is often more overlapping uncoordinated. This makes pipeline impact harder to see	Aligned work ties more clearly to outcomes, making it easier to see what drives pipeline	A closed loop learns from results and improves. Time to market shrinks while pipeline and creativity compound

Questions?

https://www.linkedin.com/in/gyalif



AI native
marketing survey

Webflow